Listen for *ideas.*

A method for each of the four parts, and how to use the second listening.

Four parts · about 30 minutes · 25 questions

THE PAPER AT A GLANCE

No. 02

Four parts, everything twice

4
parts: pictures, dialogues, notes, an interview

25
questions, one mark each

2×
you hear every recording twice

6
minutes at the end to copy your answers

Write on the question paper while you listen. Copy to the answer sheet at the end.

They won't say *the words on the page.*

Listen for the same idea in different words. If you hear the exact word from an option, be careful: it is often a trap.

Look before you listen

1. Read the question and look at all three pictures.
2. Ask: what is different between them?
3. Expect to hear all three. Only one answers the question.
4. After a suggestion, listen to the reply: yes or no?
5. Use the second listening to check.

The answer is changing

When you hear these words, the next idea often matters more:

but *actually* *although* *in the end* *instead*

"Let's take the bus… actually, the train is quicker."

How do they feel?

1. Read the first line: who is talking, and about what?
2. Read the question: a feeling, an opinion, or do they agree?
3. Listen to the whole dialogue before you choose.
4. Notice *too* and *not enough*: the speaker isn't happy.
5. Agreeing without "agree": *Exactly!* · *I'm not so sure.*

You hear… it means

scary	frightening
not very interesting	boring
enormous	huge
I'm not so sure	I disagree
I couldn't believe it	surprised

PART 3 · 6 QUESTIONS · COMPLETE THE NOTES

No. 06

Predict, then fill the gap

1. Read the notes. For each gap, guess the type: a number, a date, a place, a thing, a name?
2. The answers come in the same order as the notes.
3. Write the words you hear, usually one or two.
4. Ignore corrections: “Friday… no, sorry, Thursday.”
5. Check spelling on the second listening.

WRITE IT LIKE THIS

17th August
or 17/8 or Aug 17: all fine

£12.50 · 7.30
numbers in figures, not words

B–R–O–O–K–S
names are spelled out: know the alphabet

Follow the interviewer

1. Read all six questions first: who is the guest, and what about?
2. The interviewer's questions tell you the next item is coming.
3. Listen for the idea, not the words in A, B or C.
4. Feelings are common: listen for the feeling AND its reason.
5. Use time phrases to follow the order of events.

Tense tells the story

She has worked there for two years.

She still works there.

She worked there for two years.

She doesn't work there now.

First choose, then confirm

1

First listening

Choose or write an answer. Mark any you aren’t sure about with a small “?”.

2

Second listening

Check every answer, focus on the “?” ones, and fill any gaps.

6′

Copying time

Copy carefully to the answer sheet. Check spelling and the question numbers.

Missed something? Don’t panic. Move on, and catch it the second time.

PRACTISING AT HOME

No. 09

Train your ear every week

- Do a practice test, then read the audioscript
- Find the words that tricked you
- Learn words with their synonyms and opposites
- Find where each answer was said
- Dictate dates, prices and names to a friend
- Listen to short English podcasts or videos

Read first. Listen to the end. Then choose.

Good luck in the exam.